

GlideAggregate

vs.

getRowCount



General knowledge

The Reality Check

- `getRowCount` isn't the villain it's made out to be
- **Both methods** have their place in ServiceNow development
- The key is knowing **WHEN** to use each one, or **both at once**
- Performance impact depends on **your use case**



Filing Cabinet

Analogy



Filing Cabinet

Analogy

Scenario: You need to know how many "Urgent" files you have

Option A: The Detailed Way
(GlideRecord + getRowCount)

- Pull out all urgent files to review them (GlideRecord)
- While reviewing, keep track of how many you pulled (getRowCount)

Good when you need to actually work with the files and make changes

Filing Cabinet Analogy

Option **B**: The Quick Count Way
(**GlideAggregate**)

- Just **count** the red tabs without pulling **files out**

Perfect when you **only** need the **number!**



Filing Cabinet Analogy

Option **C**: The Hybrid Way
(**GlideAggregate** + **GlideRecord**)

- First **count** red tabs by department (**GlideAggregate**)
- Then pull out **only** the files from departments with >10 **urgent** items
- Make changes (**GlideRecord**)

Smart when you need counts **first**,
then **specific** files!

GlideRecord with getRowCount()



You're **already** querying
records for **other operations**
(create, edit, delete)

GlideAggregate

You **only** need the **count**, not the records

Need **other** aggregation functions (MAX, MIN etc.)

Need to **group** the records

Hybrid Approach

Need both **unique counts**
AND **processing**

Creating new records **based**
on aggregates

Real Performance Numbers ⚡ (PDI)

Processing 121,482 records	Time
GlideRecord	6.018 seconds
GlideAggregate	0.781 seconds
Both Combined	14.802 seconds

Pro Tips

- Don't mix methods unnecessarily
- Consider your use case first
- Think about dataset size
- Remember: Efficiency isn't just about speed





Thank you!

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